TOOL 08

AI Video Editor

Drop in raw footage, get a finished edit back

What it does

- You film. You drop the raw clips in a folder. The AI does the rest.
- It writes down every word you said, with the exact time of each word.
- It cuts out the pauses, the "umm"s and the bad takes. It keeps your best take of each line.
- It adds captions, titles, motion graphics and number counters that match your words.
- It renders a finished video file, ready to post.
- It remembers every note you give it, so each video comes out better than the last one.

Why it's built this way

The AI writes code, not clicks. An AI helper like Claude Code works with files and code, not a mouse. So the edit is made in code: a script cuts the clips, and a code-based video tool draws the graphics.

Words come first. The video is cut by the words you said, not by staring at a timeline. With a timestamp on every word, "cut the second take of line 4" is easy.

Rules live in plain text files. Every time you say "the captions are too small" or "never use that font", the AI saves it as a rule in a folder. It reads that folder before every edit. That is the whole trick.

Set up first, edit second. Most people ask for an edit on day one and get an okay result. The setup takes one evening and pays off on every video after.

Same steps every time. Transcribe, cut, check, add graphics, render.

What you need

- A computer with a few spare gigabytes of disk.
- **Claude Code** (an AI that works in a folder on your computer). A paid Claude plan: about $20 a month to start, more if you edit every day.
- **ffmpeg** (free). The workhorse that cuts and joins video and audio.
- **A Whisper-style transcriber** (free, runs on your computer). It turns speech into words with timestamps.

- **Remotion** (free for individuals and small teams; bigger companies need a paid license). It builds motion graphics and renders video from code.
- Your phone camera and a clip-on mic.

Rough monthly cost: $20 to $100 for the AI plan. The other tools are free.

Build it step by step

Open Claude Code in an empty folder, for example `my-video-editor`. Paste these one at a time.

1 Install skills and tools

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
I want you to become my video editor. I am not technical. Before any editing,
set this folder up for video work: install ffmpeg, a free Whisper-style
transcriber that gives word-level timestamps, and a Remotion project for motion
graphics. Also look for ready-made skills or guides that make you better at
Remotion and video editing, and add them. Check each one works.
```

2 Study creators you love

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Here are links to 5 videos whose editing style I love: [paste links].
Study each one. Write a file called style-notes.md with what they do:
caption style and size, where text sits, how often the shot changes, zooms,
transitions, sound effects, music, colours and fonts. End with a short list
of "do this" and "never do this".
```

3 Let it interview you

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Now interview me before you edit anything. Ask about me, my audience, this
video, the style I want, the length, the platform, and anything else you should
know. Ask one question at a time, as multiple choice with 3-4 options, plus
"other" so I can type my own. Save my answers in brief.md.
```

4 Ask what you missed

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Is there anything I didn't ask you to do, or anything you should ask me, to get
the best result? List it, ask me, and add the answers to brief.md.
```

5 Transcribe and cut

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
My raw clips are in the folder raw/. Transcribe them with word timestamps.
My script is in script.txt, one sentence per line. For each sentence, find my
best complete take (usually the last one). Cut out pauses longer than a quarter
second, filler words and false starts. Join the pieces with ffmpeg into one
clean talking video. Never let two pieces overlap, or words will repeat.
Show me a list of what you kept and what you cut.
```

6 Check the cut

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Transcribe the clean video again and compare it word by word with script.txt.
List any missing, repeated or extra words. Fix them, then check again.
```

7 Add graphics and render

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Using Remotion, add captions and motion graphics to the clean video.
Follow style-notes.md and brief.md. Tie every graphic to the word it belongs to.
Keep text away from the edges where the app buttons sit. Save a few still frames
so I can check them, then render the full video to final.mp4.
```

8 Turn feedback into rules

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Here is my feedback on this edit: [your notes]. Fix it. Then save each note as
a short rule in a folder called rules/, one file per rule, with the date. Keep
an index file that lists every rule in one line. Read all the rules before
every future edit.
```

Make it yours

- **One-command shorts.** Ask it to cut 3 short clips from every long video and make vertical versions.
- **Your own brand kit.** Give it your colours, fonts and logo once. Save them as rules.
- **Auto subtitles file.** Ask for an SRT built from your script, so names and numbers are spelled right.
- **A checklist before render.** Ask it to check its own work against the rules list and print "no problems" before it renders.

Watch out for

- **Bad audio can't be saved.** If the mic cut out or the sound is muffled, film it again. Fixing it in the edit wastes hours.
- **Don't trust one transcript.** Transcribers sometimes hide repeated words. Check the cut a second way (Step 6).
- **Renders take time and disk space.** A long video can take 30+ minutes and many gigabytes. Clear old test renders.
- **Use only footage and music you have rights to.** No clips from other creators or random stock that is not yours to use.
- **Keep secrets out.** Never paste passwords, client names or private files into the rules or the prompts.